



Above Angel Falls – the highest waterfall in the world – cascades over Mount Auyantepui in the Parque Nacional Canaima

Three Days in and around Caracas

The road from Caracas to Mérida in the Andean Mountains weaves between two mountain chains. To reach the grassy savannas of Los Llanos, you'll journey along roads hemmed by knots of ferns, palms, and vines before delving into the domain of the Venezuelan cowboy.

DAY ONE Take a **city tour** of Caracas's challenging contemporary architecture, handsome ranchos, historic houses, and extensive slums of tin huts and cardboard boxes, all overlooked by Mount Avila, which rises from the beautiful **Parque Nacional El Avila**.

DAY TWO Explore the sparsely populated **Los Llanos** countryside by driving across its picturesque rolling plains, punctuated by cattle farms and thousand-strong beef herds. Cook around an open fire on the banks of the **Orinoco**, South America's second-longest river.

DAY THREE Trek the scenic, leafy trails that loop the Andean town of **Mérida**, nestled in a verdant valley close to the **Mucuy National Park** and its crystal-clear rivers. Mérida also boasts the longest cable-car ride in the world, to the top of **Bolívar Mountain**.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Simón Bolívar International Airport in Maiquetía is 13 miles (20 km) from downtown Caracas. There are **car rentals** at the airport.

WHERE TO STAY

El Fundo de Pedernales (inexpensive) is a friendly lodge in the stunning Los Llanos plains offering guided tours. +58 256 514 5070

Hotel Plaza Mérida (moderate) is a charming 46-room hotel nestled in the mountain foothills that's packed with local art and crafts.

www.hotelplazamerida.com

Embassy Suites by Hilton (expensive), in the business district of El Rosal, Caracas, has an outdoor swimming pool, gym, and business suites. <http://embassysuites1.hilton.com>

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.inatur.gob.ve



Above Caracas sits at the foot of the slopes of the vast Mount Avila